MIL-F-15381F
31 December 1985
SUPERSEDING
MIL-F-15381E
29 April 1977

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

FOOD PACKET, SURVIVAL, AIRCRAFT LIFE RAFT

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers a special purpose food packet designed for survival and for use in life rafts in naval aircraft.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

* 2.1 Government documents. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

L-P-378	- Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin
Z-C-2104	- Candy and Chocolate Confections
QQ-A-1876	- Aluminum Foil
TT-C-495	- Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8970

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MILITARY

MIL-L-1497	- Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-C-10022	- Chewing Gum
MIL-L-35078	- Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-595	- Colors

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of documents required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

OTHER GOVERNMENT DOCUMENTS

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES (HHS)

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and
Regulations Promulgated Thereunder
(21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Market Research and Development Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

2.2 Other publications. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

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AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

F 88 - Seal Strength of Flexible Barrier Materials

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1160, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Assembly. The product shall be prepared, processed, and packaged in establishments meeting the requirements of Title 21, Code of Federal Regulations, Part 110, Current Good Manufacturing Practice in Manufacturing, Processing, Packaging, or Holding of Human Foods, and the plant sanitation requirements of the appropriate Government inspection agency.

* 3.2 Components. The food packet shall consist of the components listed in table I.

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TABLE I. Food packet components

Product	No. of units	Net weight or quantity of unit	Related specification and classification	Reference para of this document
Fruit tablets (bar)	2	28.0 grams	Z-C-2104, type V, class 1, style 1	
Chewing gum, candy-coated	2	Two tablets	MIL-C-10022, type I, flavors 2 and 3 1/	
Polyethylene bag	1	_	_	3.2.1
Twine	1	-	-	3.2.2
Instruction sheet	1	-	-	3.2.3

1/ Include both flavors in each packet.

3.2.1 Polyethylene bag. The bag shall be made from polyethylene having a minimum thickness of 0.002 inch when tested as specified in 4.4.1.1. The size of the bag shall be 3 1/2 by 6 1/2 inches.

3.2.2 Twine. The twine shall be 16 or 20 ply, No. 1-8 yarn material, and shall be 8 inches long. The twine, for use in laminated bag packets, shall be placed within the fold of the Instruction Sheet (see 3.2.3) prior to assembly. For use in aluminum cans, the twine shall be inserted into the polyethylene bag specified in 3.2.1.

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* 3.2.3 Instruction sheet. An instruction sheet of white sulphite paper of minimum basis weight of 18 pounds shall be placed in the container specified in 5.1. The sheet shall be 3 1/2 by 3 inches (± 1/8 inch in either dimension) in size and shall be folded once in either direction to 3 1/2 inches by 1 1/2 inches or 3 inches by 1 3/4 inches. The following information shall be printed on a sheet in red ink in letters no less than 1/8 inch high. The ink shall not impart any flavor or odor to the food.

(a) For use in laminated bag (see 5.1.1.1.3).

INSTRUCTIONS

The food in this packet, especially developed for survival use, will be beneficial even when water supply is limited. When entirely consumed by one man in one day, the packet will maintain survival efficiency. Items must not be allowed to get wet. Keep unused components in packet bag. Use twine (placed in the fold) to tie mouth of bag securely.

(b) For use in aluminum can (see 5.1.1.2).

INSTRUCTIONS

The food in this packet, especially developed for survival use, will be beneficial even when water supply is limited. When entirely consumed by one man in one day, the packet will maintain survival efficiency. Items must not be allowed to get wet. Keep unused components in plastic bag. Use twine to tie mouth of bag securely.

3.3 Laminated bags. Laminated bags shall comply with provisions of 5.1.1.1 when tested and examined in accordance with table V and VI.

3.4 Cans. Cans shall comply with provisions of 5.1.1.2 when tested and examined in accordance with tables V and VI.

* 4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by USDA shall not relieve the contractor of the obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all the requirements of this document. The contractor shall ensure product compliance prior to submitting the product to USDA for any inspection.

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4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. Qualification inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 Plant qualification inspection. The food packets shall be rejected if assembled and packaged in plants not meeting the requirements of 3.1.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall comply with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.4.1.1 Material examination. Material listed in table II shall be accepted on the basis of the manufacturer's certificate of conformance to the indicated requirements. Nonconformance shall indicate an unacceptable component and use of such shall be cause for rejection of the involved end item.

TABLE II. Material requirements

Material requirement	Requirement paragraph	Test procedure
Twine	3.2.2	Visual evaluation.
Instruction sheet	3.2.3	Laboratory evaluation.
Polyethylene film thickness	5.1.1.1.1	As specified in L-P-378, except that a machinist's micrometer may be used provided that its graduations and accuracy conform to the requirements of L-P-378.
Polyester film thickness	5.1.1.1.1	As above.

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TABLE II. Material requirements - Continued

Material requirement	Requirement paragraph	Test procedure
Aluminum foil thickness	5.1.1.1.1	As specified in QQ-A-1876.
Laminated material construction	5.1.1.1.1	Laboratory evaluation.
Color of laminated material	5.1.1.1.1	Visual evaluation.
Laminated bag construction	5.1.1.1.2	Laboratory evaluation.
Can and lid construction	5.1.1.2	Laboratory evaluation. Testing of can coating and labeling shall be performed in accordance with TT-C-495 and MIL-L-1497.

4.4.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the assembly, filling, and sealing of laminated bags and cans. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.4.2.1 Unfilled laminated bag examination. The bags, prior to filling, shall be examined for the defects listed in table III. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one bag. The inspection level shall be S-3, and the acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 2.5 for major defects and 4.0 for minor defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

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TABLE III. Unfilled bag defects

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Not kind of material specified
102		Not style or size specified 1/
103		Tear, hole, or open seal
	201	Not heat sealed on three sides
104		Heat seal width not as specified
105		Tear notch missing
	202	Tear notch not located 3/4 to 1 inch from bag opening 1/
	203	Depth of tear notches not as specified
106		Color not as specified

1/ Measuring device shall be calibrated in 1/32-inch increments.

4.4.3 Examination of laminated bag or can contents before sealing. The contents of the bag or can shall be examined for defects as listed in table IV. The lot size shall be expressed in bags or cans, as applicable. The sample unit shall be one filled bag or can. The inspection level shall be S-4, and AQL shall be 2.5 for major defects and 4.0 for minor defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units. The presence of any critical defect shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

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TABLE IV. Examination of laminated bag or can contents before sealing

Category			Defect
Critical	Major	Minor	
1			Less than required number of any food component
		207	Placement of component(s) not as specified
	108		Twine missing or damaged affecting usability
		208	Twine not size specified 1/
	109		Polyethylene bag in can missing or damaged, affecting usability
	110		Instruction sheet missing or required information on sheet missing, incorrect, or illegible
		209	Instruction sheet or print, not in color specified
		210	Size of instruction sheet not as specified (full size and folded) 1/
		211	Instruction sheet has prominent odor
	111		Packaging material of food component(s) not clean
	112		Wrapper of gum tablets missing, torn, or not completely enclosing tablet
	113		Wrapper of fruit tablet bar missing, torn, or not completely enclosing the bar
		212	Non-food component(s) not clean
	114		Fruit tablet bar or gum tablet broken or crushed into more than three pieces
	115		Labeling of fruit tablet bar missing, incorrect, or illegible

1/ Measuring device shall be calibrated in 1/32-inch increments.

4.4.4 Bag seal strength testing. The filled and sealed bags shall be tested for seal strength in accordance with the procedures specified in F 88 of the American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM). For the preformed bag, the average seal strength of the closure seal shall be calculated by averaging the test results of the three test specimens cut from that seal. For the form, fill, seal bag, the average seal strength of each side and end of the bag shall be calculated by averaging the test results of the three specimens cut from that side or end. The results shall be reported to the

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nearest 0.1 pound per inch in width. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed bag. The sample size shall be the number of bags indicated by inspection level S-1. Any test specimen failing to meet the requirements of 5.1.1.1.3 shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.4.5 External examination of laminated bag or can. The laminated bags or cans shall be examined for defects listed in table V. The lot size shall be expressed in bags or cans, as applicable. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed laminated bag or one filled and closed can. The inspection level shall be S-4, and the AQL shall be 1.5 for major defects and 2.5 for minor defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units. The presence of any critical defect shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

TABLE V. External examination of laminated bags or cans

Category			Defect
Critical	Major	Minor	
			Laminated bags
		217	Excess bag material
		218	Lip of bag opening less than 1/16 or more than 3/16 inch in depth 1/
	117		Labeling missing, incorrect, or illegible
	118		Assembler's seal easily pulled apart manually
	119		Width of any seal not as specified 1/
			Cans 2/
	120		Not style or size specified 1/
	121		False or improper seam
	122		Cable cut
	123		Severe dent or dent causing sharp ridge, pitted rust, or any can condition causing it to be unserviceable 2/
		219	Moderate dent
		220	Not clean 3/
2			Pull tab missing
	124		Bulging can
3			Twine or polyethylene caught in can seam

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TABLE V. External examination of laminated bags or cans - Continued

Category			Defect
Critical	Major	Minor	
4			Scoring for can lid missing or incomplete
	125		Required lithographed labeling missing, incorrect, or illegible
		221	Print smears

1/ Measuring device shall be calibrated in 1/32-inch increments.

2/ Use USDA U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers as a guide in classifying can defects.

3/ Cans showing a very thin film of grease which is discernible to the touch but not readily discernible visually are considered to be clean.

4.4.6 Filled and sealed laminated bag or can defects. The laminated bags or cans shall be examined for the defects in table VI. The lot size shall be expressed in bags or cans, as applicable. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed laminated bag or one filled and closed can. The inspection level shall be S-3, and the AQL shall be 0.65, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

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TABLE VI. Filled and sealed laminated bag or can defects

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
127		Leakage 1/
128		Delamination of bag 2/
129		Material degradation

1/ Examination for leakage: The filled and sealed bag or can shall be examined by submerging in water, contained in a desiccator or other suitable container and maintaining a vacuum of 15 inches of mercury (atmospheric pressure 29.9 inches) for at least 30 seconds. A leak is indicated by a steady progression of bubbles. Isolated bubbles caused by entrapped air are not considered as a sign of leakage.

2/ Delamination shall be scored as a defect except delamination of the outer ply when located in the seal area 1/16 inch or farther from the product edge of the seal. Bags exhibiting this type of delamination shall be tested by manually flexing the delaminated area 10 times. The area of delamination shall be held between the thumb and forefinger of each hand with both thumbs and forefingers touching each other. The delaminated area shall be rapidly flexed by rotating both hands in alternating clockwise-counterclockwise directions. Care shall be exercised when flexing delaminated area near the tear notches to avoid tearing the bag material. After flexing, the separated outer ply shall be grasped between the thumb and forefinger and gently lifted toward the food product edge of the seal. If the separated area is too small to be held between thumb and forefinger, a number 2 stylus shall be inserted into the delaminated area and gentle lifting force applied against the outer ply. If separation of the outer ply can be made to extend to less than 1/16 inch from the product edge of the seal with no discernible resistance to the gentle lifting, the bag shall be rejected.

4.4.7 Examination of can coating. Examination of exterior coating of cans shall be in accordance with quality assurance provisions of TT-C-495.

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4.4.8 Examination of can labeling. Examination of can labeling shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-1497.

4.4.9 Examination of shipping containers. Examination of the filled and closed shipping container shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions in the appendix of PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be included in the examinations:

Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible. Less than required number of laminated bags or cans in shipping containers. Top or bottom pad missing from containers of laminated bags. Reinforcement with nonmetallic strapping or tape not used.

Minor: Arrangements of cans not as specified.

4.4.10 Examination of unit loads. Unit loads shall be examined in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

* 5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A. The fruit bars and chewing gum shall be preserved level A in accordance with the applicable commodity document. The unit pack shall be a laminated bag as specified in 5.1.1.1 or an aluminum can as specified in 5.1.1.2 (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Laminated bag. The components listed in table I, except for the polyethylene bag, which shall be deleted from this unit pack, shall be assembled in a bag fabricated from the material specified in 5.1.1.1.1. The bag shall be constructed in accordance with 5.1.1.1.2 and shall be filled and closed as specified in 5.1.1.1.3.

5.1.1.1.1 Material. The material shall consist of 0.002-inch thick polyethylene film laminated or extrusion coated to 0.00035-inch thick aluminum foil, laminated on the plain side to 0.0005-inch polyester. The polyester shall be bonded to the aluminum foil by hot extruding 10 pounds per ream of polyethylene between the laminate. The exterior surface of the material shall be colored overall with a color in the number range of 34079 to 34087 inclusive, or 30045 through 30118, except color 30109 is not permitted. If reverse printing of the polyester is used or if pigment is applied with the adhesive used for laminating the polyester to the aluminum foil, colors from

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14036 to 14087 or from 10045 to 10080 inclusive will be acceptable. The material shall show no evidence of material degradation or delamination (see table VI) when made into bags or when closed by heat sealing.

5.1.1.1.2 Bags. The bag shall be a flat style bag having inside dimensions of 3 by 6 1/2 inches (± 1/8 inch) with the opening of the bag located on the 3-inch edge. All seams, including folded edge when envelope is made from a single piece of folded material, and the closure seal shall be made by heat sealing. Side and bottom seals shall be 3/8 (± 1/8) inch wide. Tear notches at least 1/32 inch deep shall be provided on both side seals, and shall be 3/4 to 1 inch from the open edge of the bag. The distance between the inside edge of the tear notch and the inside edge of the heat seal shall be at least
1/8 inch. A 1/8 (± 1/16)-inch extended or foldover lip may be provided at the open end of the bag to facilitate opening and filling.

5.1.1.1.3 Filling and sealing. The components shall be assembled into the bag by placing the folded instruction sheet, enclosing the twine, along the side of the two bars. The two gum packets shall be positioned flat between the bars. Care shall be taken to expel all excess air prior to sealing the bag. The bag shall be closed with a continuous heat seal closure not less than 1/4 or more than 3/4 inch wide extending across the complete width of the bag. If a thermal impulse sealer is used or combination of heated curved bar with thermal impulse, any seal width from 1/8 to 7/16 inch will be acceptable. Both the bag manufacturer's seals (see 5.1.1.1.2) and the closure seal shall have an average seal strength of 6 pounds per square inch of width and each individual test specimen shall have a seal strength of not less than 5 pounds per inch width when tested in accordance with 4.4.4. The filled and sealed bag shall show no evidence of leakage when examined in accordance with footnote 1 of table VI.

5.1.1.2 Aluminum can. The components listed in table I shall be packaged flat in the most compact manner in a 1/4 drawn aluminum can. The can size shall be 405 by 301 by 014.5. The aluminum can shall be fitted with a pull tab scored lid for 3/4 easy panel removal. The can lid shall be compound lined and have a double seamed closure. The can lid shall be made from (0.0105 inch) 5052 aluminum alloy and shall be coated overall outside, including seam area, with a coating conforming to type I or II of TT-C-495. Care shall be exercised to prevent bulging or catching the twine or polyethylene bag in the can seam in the closing operation. The filled and sealed can shall not show leakage when examined in accordance with footnote 1 of table VI.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level B or C, as specified (see 6.1).

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5.2.1 Level B packing. Thirty-six bags or cans, preserved as specified in 5.2, arranged 3 in length, 4 in width, and 3 in depth, shall be packed flat in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed, closed, and reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with style RSC, V3c of PPP-B-636. The box for laminated bags shall be 10 7/8 inches in length, 8 1/2 inches in width, and 3 inches in depth, and shall be provided with top and bottom pads made of non-test corrugated fiberboard. The box for aluminum cans shall be 13 inches in length, 12 1/4 inches in width, and 3 inches in depth. Shipping containers shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level C packing, for shipment to ration assembler. Bags or cans shall be packed in containers that are acceptable to common carriers for safe transportation to the destination specified in shipping instructions at the lowest rate for such supplies. Shipping containers shall be in accordance with the Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

5.3 Unit loads. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class specified.

5.4 Labeling and marking. Printing for all labels shall be black, boldface, legible type with indelible ink.

5.4.1 Bar wrapper for fruit tablets. The outside of the wrapper for each bar shall be labeled as follows:

FRUIT TABLETS
(Name and address of manufacturer)

5.4.2 Laminated bags. Each bag shall be printed on the lip side in permanent ink in large clear black letters as follows:

FOOD PACKET, SURVIVAL, AIRCRAFT, LIFE RAFT
Date of manufacture
(Name and address of assembler)

Open bag carefully, retain bag to store unused components by tying securely with twine provided.

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5.4.3 Cans. Cans shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497. In addition, the top of the cans shall be lithographed with the following information:

FOOD PACKET, SURVIVAL, AIRCRAFT, LIFE RAFT
Date of manufacture
(Name and address of assembler)

5.4.4 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.4.5 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078 and as specified in the contract.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. Type of unit pack required (see 5.1).
c. Selection of applicable level of packing (see 5.2).
d. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is specified (see 5.3).

6.2 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this document are marked with an asterisk (*) to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue have been made. This was done as a convenience only and the the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-F-15381	Food Packet, Survival, Aircraft Life Raft

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NATICK OP, 1 Apr 84

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